SCOUT RECON

AI-POWERED LISTING MANAGEMENT

USER GUIDE
Version 6.0 | March 2026

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1 GETTING STARTED -- SIGNING IN

Scout Recon is accessed via any web browser at **www.scout-recon.com**. Access is invite-only. Two sign-in methods are supported:

Google Sign-In	Click **Operator Google Access** and authenticate with your Gmail account. Fastest option -- no password to manage.
Email / Password	Enter your **Email ID** and **Security Key**, then click **Enter Console**. You will receive a password-setup email from admin@scout-recon.com when your account is created.

NOTE Your account must be approved by the administrator before sign-in will succeed. Contact admin@scout-recon.com if access is denied.

2 APPLICATION LAYOUT

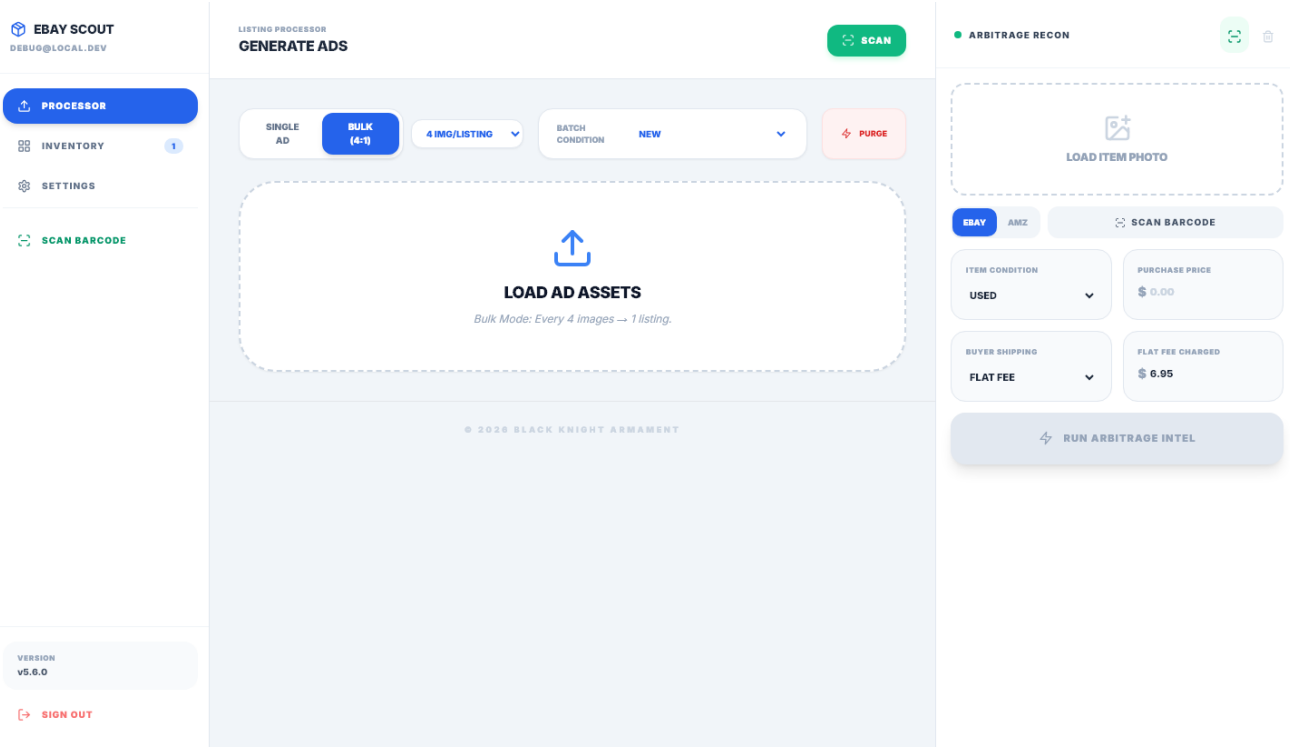

Fig 1 -- Scout Recon desktop layout. Left nav | Centre workspace | Right Arbitrage Recon panel.

Left Navigation	Switch between Processor, Inventory, Settings, and Scan Barcode.
Centre Workspace	Primary work area -- changes based on the active tab.

Arbitrage Recon	Always-visible panel on the right for quick item research and arbitrage analysis.
SCAN button	Top-right shortcut to open the barcode camera scanner.

3 LISTING PROCESSOR -- GENERATING ADS

The Processor is the core feature of Scout Recon. Upload product photos and the AI automatically generates a complete eBay listing -- title, description, item specifics, price research, and category assignment.

3.1 Single Ad Mode

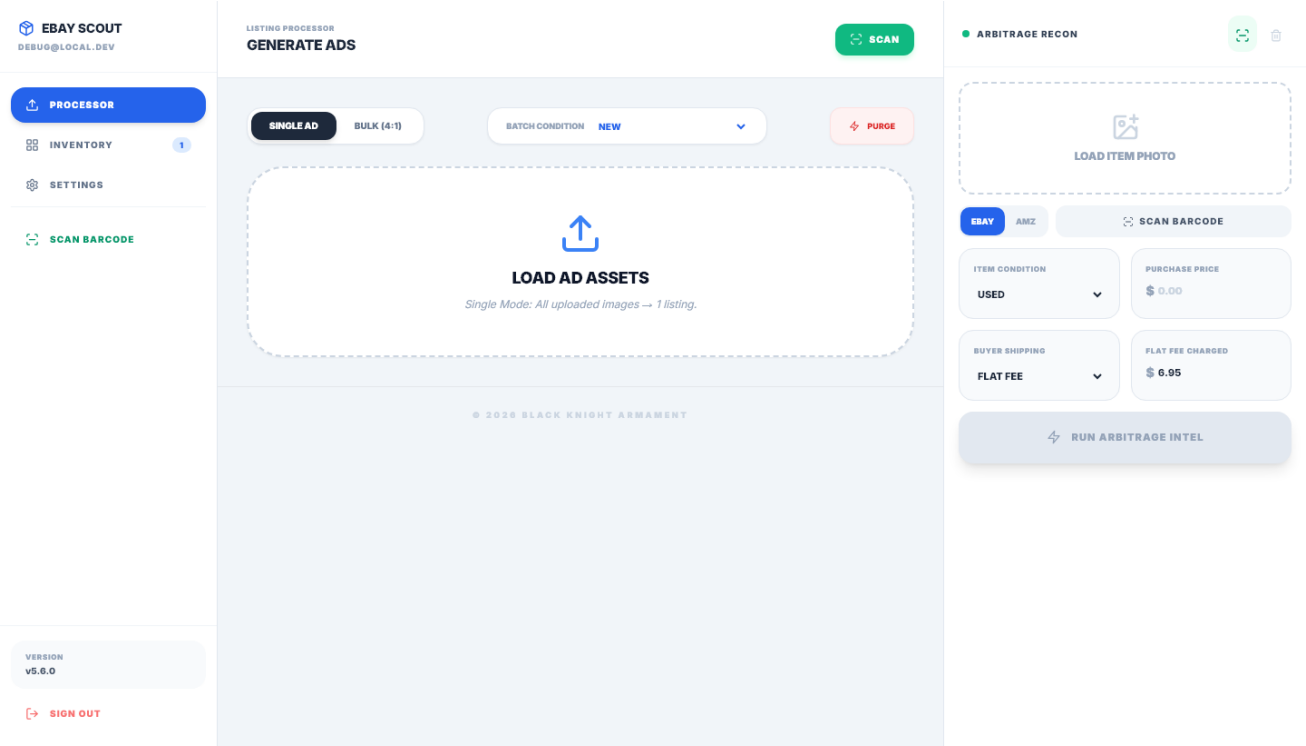

Fig 2 -- Single Ad mode. All uploaded images are grouped into one listing.

Use **Single Ad** when all of your photos represent one item. Upload any number of images and the AI generates a single, comprehensive listing using all of them.

1. Click **SINGLE AD** in the mode toggle.
2. Select the item's **Batch Condition** from the dropdown (e.g. Used, New, Like New).
3. Click the dashed upload zone or drag and drop your images.
4. Click **Generate Inventory Ads**. Processing takes 10-20 seconds.
5. The completed listing appears in the **Inventory** tab.

3.2 Bulk Mode

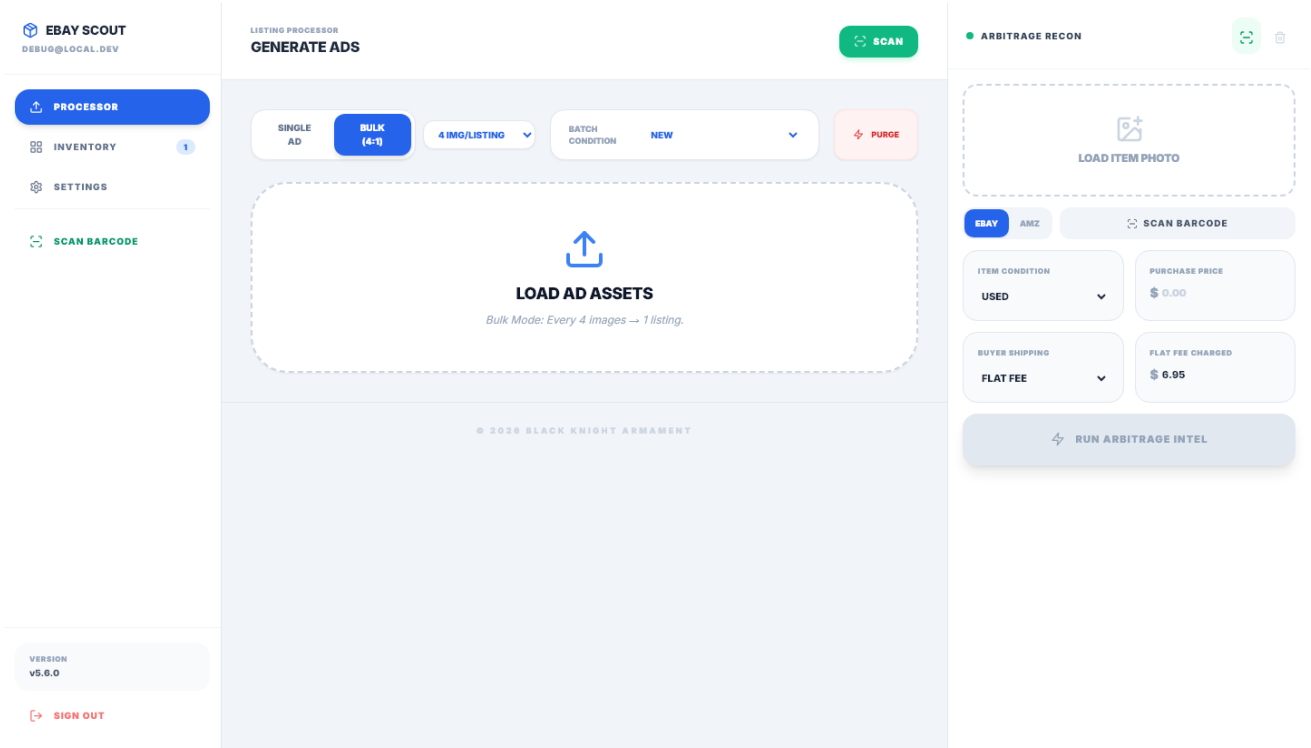

Fig 3 -- Bulk mode with images-per-listing selector.

Use **Bulk** when photographing multiple items in one session. Scout Recon groups images into listings based on your selected images-per-listing setting.

1. Click **BULK** in the mode toggle.
2. Use the **IMG/LISTING** dropdown to set how many images per listing (1-10).
3. Upload all images for the session -- they are grouped automatically.
4. Click **Generate Inventory Ads**. Each group generates one listing.

TIP	12 photos with 4 IMG/LISTING selected = 3 listings generated simultaneously.

3.3 Batch Condition

Set the condition that applies to all items in this batch before uploading. Options include **New, Like New, Very Good, Good, Acceptable**. The condition is applied to every listing generated in the session and can be adjusted per-listing in Inventory afterward.

3.4 Remove BG -- Processor Toggle

NEW v6.0	Background removal runs entirely in your browser -- no API key, no third-party service, no cost.

The **Remove BG** toggle is a purple pill button in the Processor controls row, next to Single Ad / Bulk and Batch Condition. When enabled, every image in your upload batch has its background stripped by an on-device AI model *before* being sent to Cloudinary -- only the clean, transparent image is stored.

Output: **WebP format, max 1024 x 1024 px, alpha channel preserved**. Typical file size: 200-600 KB vs 5-10 MB for an unprocessed raw photo.

1. Click **Remove BG** in the Processor controls row -- the button turns purple when active.
2. Upload your images as normal (drag-and-drop or tap to select).
3. Click **Generate Inventory Ads**.
4. On first use, the status bar shows *"Loading BG removal model..."* while the AI model downloads (~50 MB, browser-cached after that). Subsequent sessions load instantly.
5. Processing continues normally. Images appear in Inventory with transparent backgrounds.

TIP	Enable when items have cluttered or distracting backgrounds. The AI model is cached by your browser after the first download -- only the initial load requires extra time.

NOTE	Background removal adds processing time per image. For large time-sensitive batches, leave the toggle off and clean up individual listings using the per-card Remove BG button in Inventory (see Section 4.4).

4 INVENTORY -- MANAGING LISTINGS

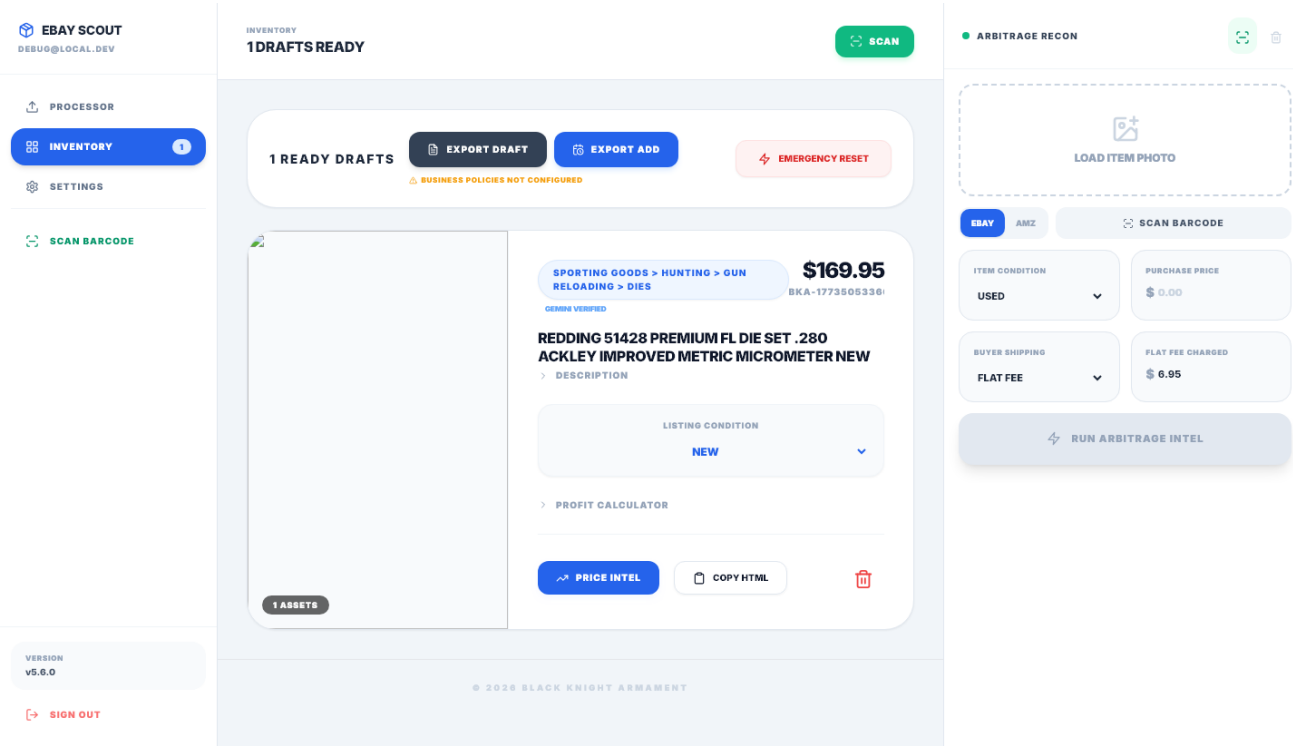

Fig 4 -- Inventory tab showing ready drafts and export controls.

All generated listings are stored in Inventory as drafts. From here you can review, edit, research pricing, calculate profit, and export to eBay.

4.1 Profit Calculator

Each listing card has a collapsed **Profit Calculator** section. Click it to expand, then enter your **Purchase Price**. The calculator automatically deducts:

- eBay Final Value Fee (default 13.25%)
- Payment processing fee (default 2.9% + $0.30)
- Your shipping cost (set in Settings)

The result shows **Net Profit ($)** and **Margin (%)** with color coding -- green for profitable, amber for marginal, red for a loss.

TIP	Purchase price is saved automatically per listing. Fee defaults can be changed in Settings > Fees & Costs.

4.2 Price Intelligence

Click **Price Intel** on any listing card to run a live eBay market analysis. The AI returns a recommended price range (Low / Mid / High) with a confidence rating and a brief rationale based on current sold listings.

The **recommended price (Mid)** is automatically applied as the listing price. You can manually edit the price directly on the card.

4.3 Exporting to eBay

Scout Recon exports listings in eBay's standard CSV format for bulk upload via Seller Hub.

Export Draft	Downloads a draft CSV. Upload to eBay Seller Hub > Reports > Upload. Listings appear as drafts for review before going live.
Export Add	Downloads an Add CSV with a scheduled go-live time. On desktop, a date/time picker lets you choose the schedule. On mobile, the default is +7 days from now.

How to upload the CSV to eBay:

1. Go to **eBay Seller Hub > Reports > Upload**
2. Select **Active listings** (Add) or **Draft listings** (Draft)
3. Choose your exported CSV file and click **Upload**
4. eBay processes the file and confirms listings created

4.4 Remove BG -- Inventory Card

Each listing card has a per-image **Remove BG** button that appears when you hover over the primary photo. Use this to clean up individual listing backgrounds after processing -- no need to reprocess the entire batch.

1. Hover over the primary image on any listing card.
2. Click the **Remove BG** button (scissors icon, top-right corner of the image).
3. Status toasts show progress: *Loading model... > Removing background... > Uploading...*
4. The primary image (first asset) is replaced with the background-removed version. Additional images (assets 2+) are preserved unchanged.

TIP	The AI model (~50 MB) is shared between the Processor toggle and the per-card button -- if you have used either during the session, the other loads instantly.

NOTE	Remove BG replaces only the **primary** listing image. For batch background removal across many listings, use the Processor toggle (Section 3.4) before generating ads.

5 ARBITRAGE RECON

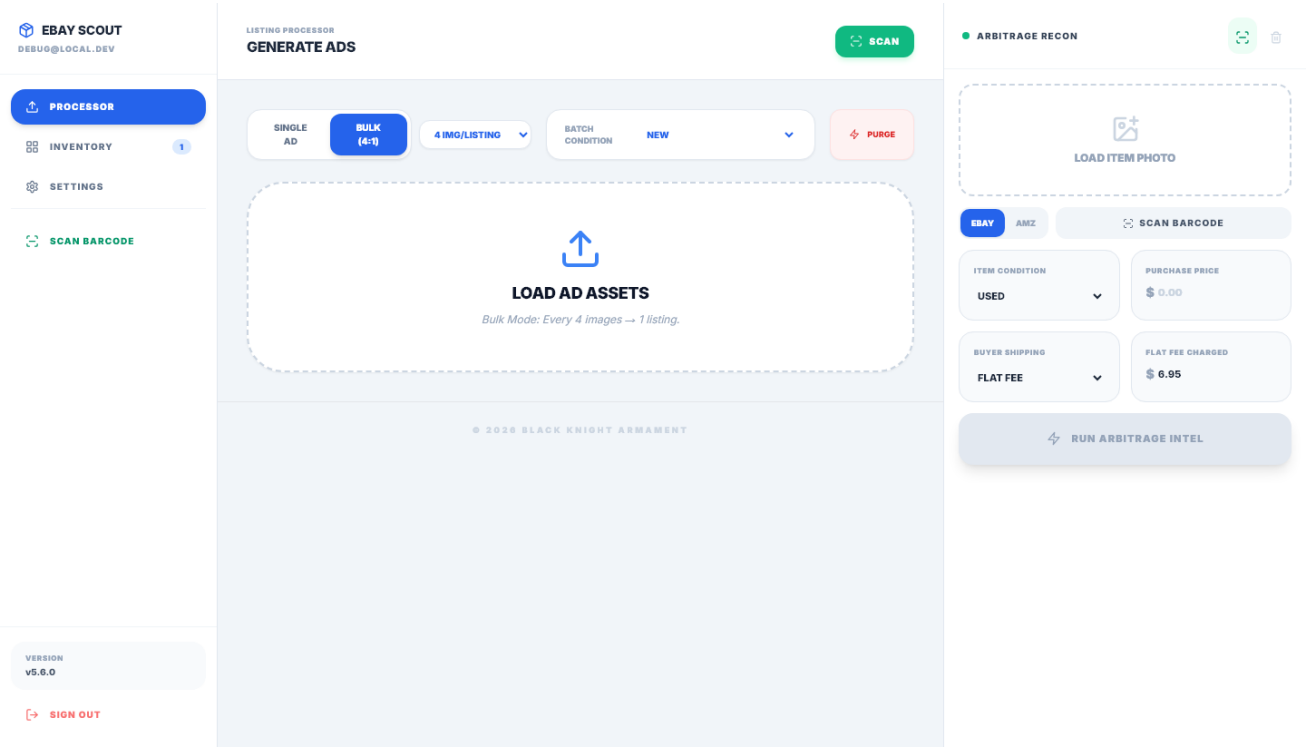

Fig 5 -- Arbitrage Recon panel. Always visible on the right side of the screen.

Arbitrage Recon is a rapid profitability analysis tool. Use it to evaluate whether an item is worth purchasing for resale before you commit. It combines image analysis, barcode lookup, and live market pricing into a single **GO / MARGINAL / NO-GO** verdict.

5.1 Barcode Scanning

The Recon panel includes a barcode scanner that looks up items on eBay or Amazon. The **eBay / AMZ toggle** sets which marketplace is searched by default when you scan.

1. Select your default scan marketplace using the **eBay / AMZ toggle**.
2. Click **Scan Barcode** to open the camera scanner.
3. Point the camera at the item's barcode -- it triggers automatically.
4. Results appear showing matching listings with prices.
5. Click any result to load it as the Recon item, or switch to the other marketplace to compare.

TIP	On mobile, barcode scanning uses the device camera only. On desktop, a USB scan gun or the camera can both be used.

5.2 Running Arbitrage Analysis

Once an item is loaded (via barcode scan or photo upload), fill in the Recon fields and run the analysis:

Item Condition	Set the condition of the item you found (Used, Like New, etc.)
Purchase Price	What you would pay to acquire the item.
Buyer Shipping	How you plan to charge the buyer -- Flat Fee, Free, or Pickup.
Flat Fee Charged	If Flat Fee is selected, enter the shipping amount charged to the buyer.

Click **Run Arbitrage Intel**. The AI analyzes the item and returns a full breakdown:

GO	Net profit >= $15. Strong buy recommendation.
MARGINAL	Net profit $5-$15. Worth buying at the right price.
NO-GO	Net profit below $5. Not recommended at this price.

TIP A promising Recon result can be sent directly to the Processor with one tap to generate a full eBay listing immediately.

6 SETTINGS

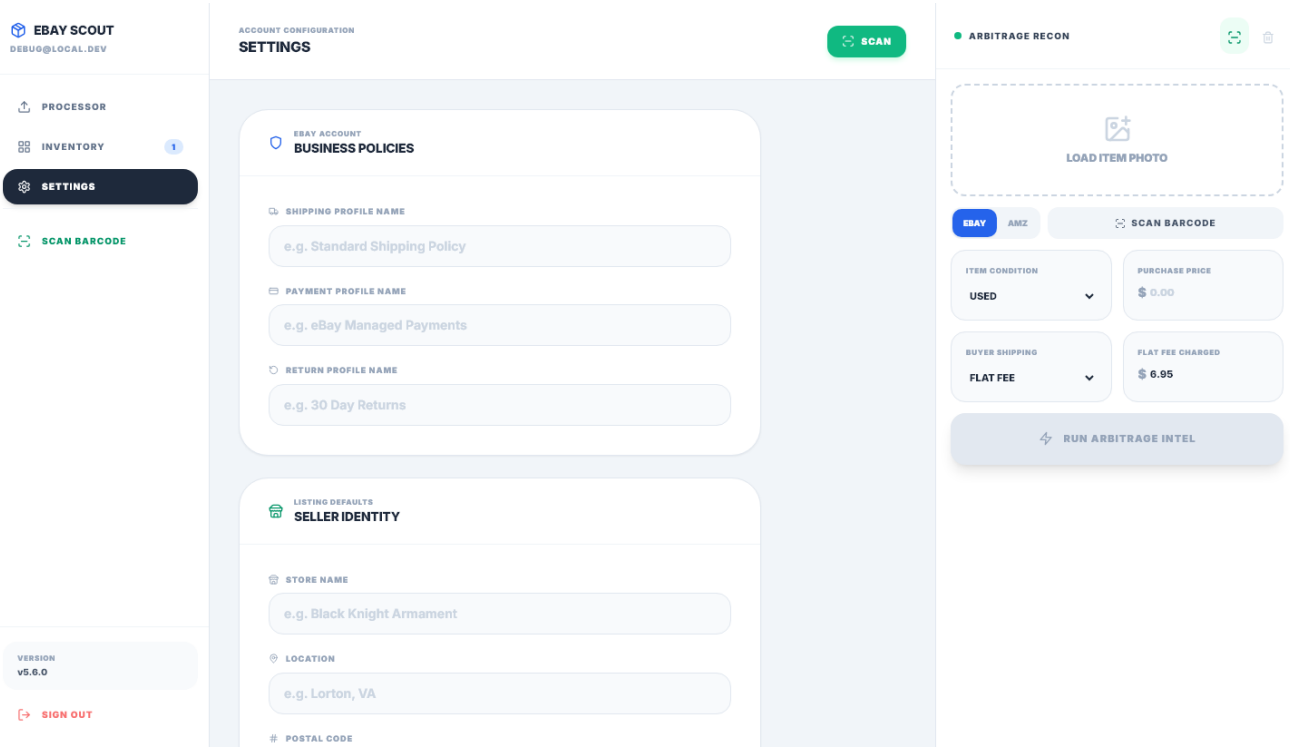

Fig 6 -- Settings: Business Policies and Seller Identity.

Business Policies	Shipping Profile Name, Payment Profile Name, Return Profile Name -- must match exactly what is configured in your eBay Seller Hub business policies.
Seller Identity	Store Name, Location, and Postal Code -- embedded in every exported CSV.
Fees & Costs	Shipping Cost ($), eBay FVF (%), Payment Fee (%), Payment Fee Flat ($). Used by the Profit Calculator on every listing card.
Ad Footer	Custom text appended to the bottom of every generated ad description and CSV export. Leave blank to omit. Ideal for offer policies, return terms, and shipping notes.

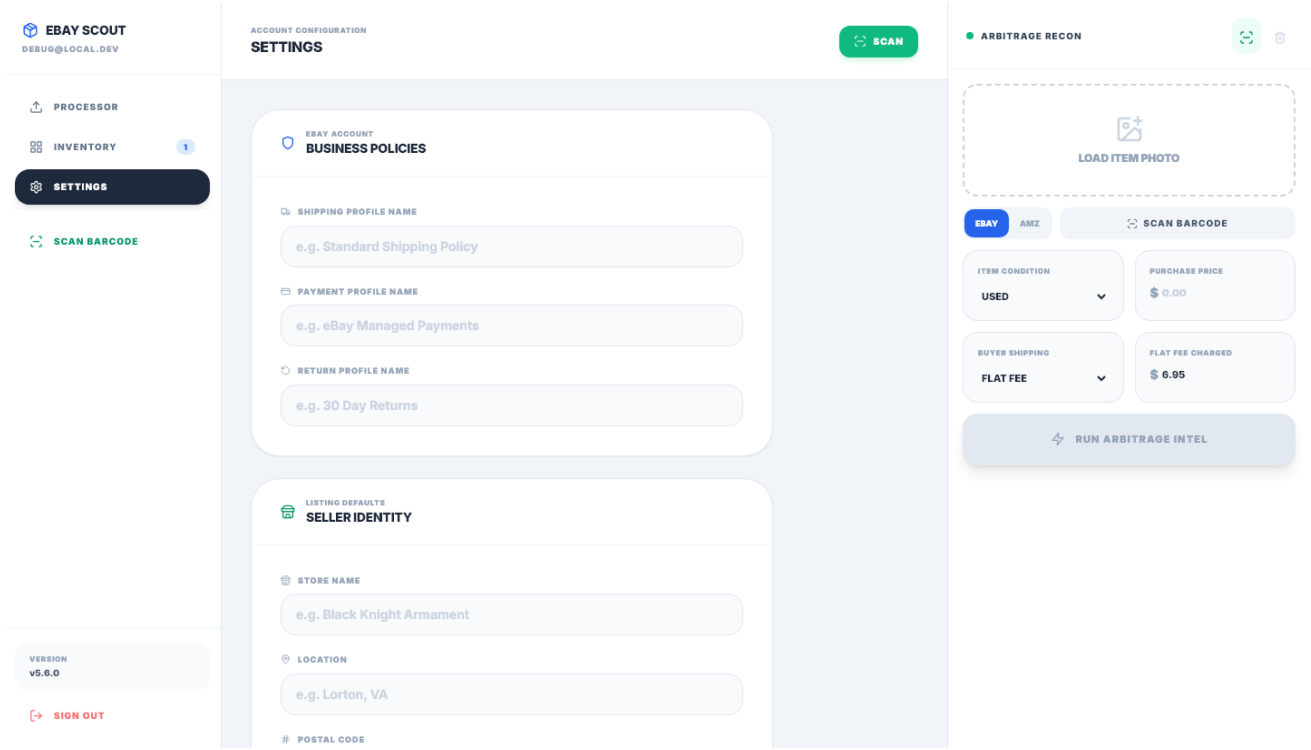

Fig 7 -- Fees & Costs and Ad Footer settings.

IMPORTANT	Always click **Save Settings** after making changes. Settings are saved per user account and persist across sessions and devices.

7 CORE WORKFLOW -- END TO END

The following is the standard workflow from photographing items to live eBay listings.

1. **Configure Settings**
   Set your eBay business policy names, store name, location, postal code, shipping cost, and fee percentages. Do this once -- settings persist.

2. **Photograph Items**
   Take clear photos of each item. For Single Ad mode, any number of photos per item. For Bulk, group photos in sets matching your IMG/LISTING setting.

3. **Select Mode & Condition**
   Choose Single AD or BULK on the Processor tab. Set the Batch Condition for the session. Enable Remove BG (optional) to strip backgrounds before upload.

4. **Upload & Generate**
   Drag and drop (or tap to select) your photos into the upload zone. Click Generate Inventory Ads. Processing takes 10-20 seconds per listing.

5. **Review in Inventory**
   Navigate to the Inventory tab. Review each listing -- check the title, description, category, and suggested price. Use the per-card Remove BG button (hover the image) to clean up individual photos.

6. **Run Price Intel (optional)**
   Click Price Intel on any listing to get AI-powered market pricing. The recommended price updates automatically.

7. **Calculate Profit (optional)**
   Expand the Profit Calculator on each card. Enter your purchase price to confirm profitability before exporting.

8. **Export CSV**
   Click Export Draft (for review) or Export Add (to schedule a go-live time). A CSV file downloads to your device.

9. **Upload to eBay Seller Hub**
   Go to eBay Seller Hub > Reports > Upload. Select Draft or Active and upload your CSV. eBay confirms listings created.

For support, contact **admin@scout-recon.com**

www.scout-recon.com